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Reading from Mr. Lewis
No. 123
Confidential

Rd. Aug. 21

Japanese Audience.
Loan Formosa.

* In the Lower House Mr Shidehara criticised

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Pekin
June 4th 1873

43
Initial

My Lord,

The Japanese Ambassador, Soyesima, paid me a long visit yesterday morning. I had met him a few nights before at the French Legation, and among other matters I had told him that, at his convenience, I wished to ask him, for the information of my Government, a question or two regarding Corea and

Wd Granville K.G.

Japan

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Japan.

Some allusion to the slowness of the Chinese as compared with the acceptiveness of the Japanese enabled me to repeat an observation I had made when we last met, regarding the Ambassador. I had heard that the Ambassador had been recommended, {by my Russian Colleague,} to insist upon being received alone, and I had found the Ambassador inclined the more to this advice

On

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on the ground that his mission
was of a special character. Promising
that I gave due weight to the
arguments, and that I did not
wish to press my own opinions
obtrusively upon him, I had
advocated rather the acceptance
of whichever arrangement the
Chinese might prefer.

The Ambassador had
sent me a dark with an Essay
upon the Audience question written
upon it: his thesis being the
first

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five relations of mine. In return
I had given him one with a
copy of a Chinese version of
Longfellow's Psalm of Life, and
it was thus that we came
back to the question. Referring
with some apology to our previous
conversation I said that I fully
agreed with him in that he
had urged upon the Secretary
of State for War as a friend

See No. 156
of May 24th

and

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and friend; but that this was
the great difficulty of Chinese
Tradition, and that, for this
cause, as I had mentioned
before, I was for management
on every other point provided
that reception were accorded us,
the Foreign Ministers, on terms
not derogatory to the dignity
of our Governments.

Soyesima certainly
did

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did not subscribe this —a—
proposition with any cordiality.
He seems to me by no means
ready to admit that China
need move slower than Japan
has moved, and though I did
not ignore the Chinese for their
slowness, he regards me, I think,
as too pro-Chinese to be trusted
in what regards them as much
as he has trusted some of my

Colleagues

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Colleagues. I shall speak of this elsewhere. He confirmed what I had heard, that the Yamen had invited him to communicate his opinions regarding the etiquette to be observed. He told me that he had been consulted even about details. At the same time I know from other sources, that he states himself to have told the Yamen that the prescription of the ceremonial lay with the Chinese Government. It would be

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be for him to accept or decline
that was prescribed when he
knew of it. His foreign —
coadjutor, General Legendre,
declares that, in his correspondence
with the Yamun, the Ambassador
has taken a very high tone.
But it would appear from the
admissions of the same person,
that when the Prince of Hung
returned the Ambassador's visit
two days ago, his Highness was
very brusque in his manners

to

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to the whole Japanese mission.
He was evidently determined
not to talk on business, and as
the Ambassador was equally
determined to talk of nothing
else, the Ministers accompanying
the Prince resorted to their
usual tactics, all beginning to
talk at the same moment about
other matters.

All this was the more
remarkable, as in his visits,
paid

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paid him seven days. To the Dutch
Representative and the German
Chargé d'Affaires. The Prince
had been more than usually
courteous.

Be this as it may a
correspondence is now under way
more or less angry in character.

As to Korea, Soyesima
said that his Government was
not at the moment contemplating
a descent upon Korea, but pacific
negotiations

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negotiations with a view to the improvement of intercourse. He did not even hint in plain words that refusal of the concession might lead to its execution, but I inferred from his way of talking that this is a rock ahead. Meanwhile he is evidently anxious for an assurance from the Chinese that Corea is an independent Kingdom, so independent of China, that is to say, as to

make

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make what may befall Korea
no concern of the Chinese.

About Formosa he
was more reticent, or I might
say, less candid. The murder of
Liu-chiu-ans by Formosan Savages
had to excited the Japanese, he
declared, that the Government
had with difficulty restrained
the people from immediate
war. From 10,000 to 20,000 troops
were now ready to move, should

China

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China did adequately do — guarantee the good behaviour of the Formosans; I do not think indemnity was hinted at; and these troops would have to be passed through that part {the western coast} of Formosa over which China exercises jurisdiction, in order to approach the tribes who are to be punished.

Supposing all this to be bonâ fide, it is plain that both

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with Korea Japan is about to
deal, much as China and Japan
herself have been dealt with
by Western nations; while, in
Formosa, there will be a curious
analogy between the position
taken by the Japanese and the
Russian practice for continued
occupation of East Turkestan.
In both instances China is
made to feel that if she
cannot

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Cannot or will not govern her
nominal Territories. They will
be occupied by those who are
interested in their retention.

I have the honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord,
your Lordship's most obedient
humble Servant
Thomas Francis Wade -